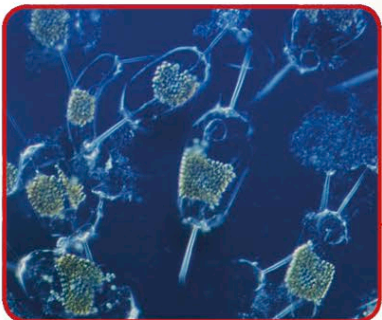


1 Sunlight

When the sun is shining brightly, a single square meter of ocean surface collects more than a thousand joules of energy every second—enough to power a microwave oven.

**2 Phytoplankton**

Plankton are tiny organisms that float in the water in billions. They contain algae called phytoplankton that make food by photosynthesis. Because they harness their energy directly from the sun, they are called the producers in a food chain.

3 Zooplankton

Tiny animals, called zooplankton, feed on the phytoplankton. Including a variety of shrimps and fish larvae, these are the primary consumers—animals that eat only algae or plants. They make up the second stage of a food chain.

4 Herring

The Pacific herring is a key link in the ocean food chain—an omnivore that eats both phytoplankton and zooplankton. It is the secondary consumer of the chain, and swims in large shoals that are easily snapped up by bigger predators.

Food waste

In deeper, darker parts of the ocean there is not enough light for photosynthesis, so food chains here often rely on dead organisms falling down through the water.

Photosynthesis by ocean-dwelling phytoplankton generates around 70 percent of the oxygen in the air.

When seabirds eat fish and return to shore, they transfer some of the energy of the ocean food chain to the land.

The bodies of dead animals sink into the depths, where they are eaten by scavengers and decomposers.

